

Sushi Burrito

Tempura shrimp · California crab · fresh tuna · full-sheet nori, rolled tight

YIELD	ACTIVE	RICE RATIO	DIFFICULTY
2 large burritos	25–30 min	1:1 rice:water	Easy

KEY TARGETS

Four numbers decide whether it holds together

COMPONENT	TARGET	WHY IT MATTERS
Rice temp	Body temp, 95–100°F	Too hot = soggy nori; too cold = clumps, won't stick
Rice seasoning	3 : 2 : 0.5 vinegar:sugar:salt	Brightness cuts the fish richness — balance is everything
Nori texture	Crisp at assembly	Wet nori = chewy mess; work fast or toast fresh
Tuna temp	Ice cold, 35–38°F	Warmth = bacteria growth and mushy texture

INGREDIENTS

Per 2 burritos — sauces converted to grams

RICE

Sushi rice short grain	300 g
Water 1:1 by weight	300 g
Rice vinegar	60 g
Sugar	25 g
Salt	6 g

SAUCES

Kewpie mayo	45 g
Sriracha	15 g
Eel sauce unagi	40 g
Good shoyu to dip	—

PROTEINS

Sushi-grade tuna cubed	170 g
Imitation crab surimi	115 g
Tempura shrimp frozen	6–8 pcs

FILLINGS

Avocado sliced	1 whole
Cucumber julienned	½ whole
Green onion sliced	2 stalks
Lemon paper-thin	½ whole
Nori sheets full size	2 sheets

METHOD

Rice, Prep & Roll

METHOD

Rice first — everything else waits on it cooling to body temp

- 1 **Rinse:** rice in a fine mesh strainer, agitate under cold water until it runs **crystal clear** (2–3 min).
- 2 **Cook:** pressure cooker — **300 g rice + 300 g water** (1:1 by weight), high pressure **3 min**, natural release **10 min**. Tender, separate grains.
- 3 **Season:** warm vinegar + sugar + salt until dissolved. Transfer hot rice to a wide bowl, **drizzle while cutting/folding** (not stirring), and fan to **body temp, glossy**.
- 4 **Crab mix:** shred surimi by hand into thin strips, mix with **30 g Kewpie** + a pinch of salt — creamy and cohesive.
- 5 **Spicy mayo:** combine **15 g Kewpie + 15 g sriracha**; adjust toward 2:1 for hotter, 3:1 for milder.
- 6 **Tempura:** from frozen — air fryer **400°F, 8–10 min**, flip halfway (oven: 425°F, 12–15 min). Golden, crispy.
- 7 **Prep veg:** avocado thin, cucumber into matchsticks, green onion on the bias, lemon mandolined paper-thin. Uniform cuts.
- 8 **Lay nori:** shiny-side down on a dry surface; if humid, flash-toast over a flame ~2 sec/side so it's crisp.
- 9 **Spread rice:** wet hands; spread **~150 g rice** over the center third, leaving a **½" border** top and bottom to seal. **~¼"** thick, even.
- 10 **Fill:** layer across the center — tuna, crab mix, tempura shrimp, avocado, cucumber, lemon, green onion. Drizzle spicy mayo + eel sauce. **Don't overfill.**
- 11 **Roll:** fold the bottom edge over the filling and tuck tight; continue away from you keeping tension; seal the edge with a wet finger.
- 12 **Cut:** wet a sharp knife, cut in half on the bias, wipe the blade between cuts for a clean face.

Fix It & Riff

TROUBLESHOOTING

PROBLEM	CAUSE	FIX
Rice sticky / clumpy	Overworked or too hot	Cut and fold, don't stir; fan while seasoning
Nori chewy	Got wet during assembly	Work faster; toast over a flame if humid
Falls apart	Overfilled or loose roll	Less filling; tuck tight on the first fold

VARIATIONS

Same roll, different build

NAME	BUILD	NOTES
Oregon	In: spicy Dungeness crab, cucumber, avocado. Top: salmon, lemon	Real crab + spicy mayo
Hamachi Lover	In: yellowtail, salmon, serrano. Top: yellowtail, lemon	Fresh serrano heat
Rainbow	In: crab mix, cucumber, avocado. Top: assorted fish	Classic multi-fish
Ms. Ginny	In: spicy tuna, cucumber, salmon. Top: red snapper, white tuna	Wife's favorite
The Hawaiian	In: spicy tuna, cucumber, avocado. Top: yellowtail, cilantro, lemon	Wife's favorite

Shoyu: Yamasa or Marukin straight, or mix **3 : 1 : 1 shoyu : rice vinegar : mirin** with a squeeze of lemon. **Tuna:** don't refreeze once thawed — if buying bulk, portion while still firm. **Rice ratio (memorize it):** 300 g rice : 300 g water : 60 g vinegar : 25 g sugar : 6 g salt. **Lemons:** a mandoline is the only way to get them paper-thin.